

53 CASES · 2004 TO 2025

The Evidence Trap

Why fact-based conflicts never settle

THE PATTERN

In political cases, the committee gathers evidence, rules, and moves on. The evidence phase clears within the first third of the timeline. In science and geopolitics, the evidence phase never fully releases. The argument loops back, demands more proof, and the case starves for a decision that facts alone cannot deliver.

WHAT WIKIPEDIA'S LAST RESORT REVEALS

The Arbitration Committee is Wikipedia's court of **last resort**. Cases only reach it after every lower forum has failed. When those cases cluster around disputed **facts** rather than disputed **conduct**, they stay open longer because the committee cannot rule on what reality is. It can only manage behavior around the disagreement. The evidence trap is not a process failure. It is a signal that some conflicts are structurally beyond arbitration's reach.





Conflict Fingerprints Ten Lenses SARC 5400 · UVA Data Viz · Final Project